



Delhi Public School, Howrah

PRE-BOARD EXAMINATION - II (2025-2026)

Class- X

Care must be taken not to write anything on the question paper. All the questions must be attempted in the correct sequence.

SUBJECT: ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (CODE - 184)

Time allowed: - 3 Hours

Maximum Marks - 80

General instructions:

Read the instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.

2. The question paper contains THREE sections –

Section – A: Reading Skills

Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills

Section – C: Literature Textbook

3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION A

READING SKILLS

(20 marks)

1. Read the following passage.

10

- Lionel Messi's proposed India tour has sparked widespread excitement, intense media coverage, and equally strong debate. As one of the most celebrated footballers in history, Messi's arrival in India is seen by many as a landmark moment for Indian sports. However, beyond the glamour and fanfare, the tour raises important questions about the real impact of celebrity visits on the development of sports in the country.
- Supporters of Messi's India tour argue that such visits play a powerful inspirational role. For young football enthusiasts, seeing a global icon in person can ignite passion and ambition. Messi's journey—from a child facing physical challenges to a World Cup champion—offers a compelling narrative of perseverance and discipline. His presence can encourage students to view sports as a serious career option rather than merely a recreational activity. Additionally, the global attention generated by the tour places India on the international football map, potentially attracting future collaborations and investments.
- On the other hand, critics question whether short-term celebrity appearances translate into long-term growth. They argue that while public events and promotional matches generate excitement, they do little to address structural issues such as lack of grassroots training, inadequate infrastructure, and limited access to professional coaching. Without sustained investment in local talent and school-level sports programmes, the influence of such tours may fade quickly once the celebrity leaves.
- There is also debate about the economic priorities involved. Organising high-profile visits requires substantial financial resources, leading some to ask whether the same funds could be better used to develop local leagues, improve playgrounds, or train coaches. While the tour may boost tourism and brand value, its cost-effectiveness in strengthening Indian football remains uncertain.
- In conclusion, Messi's India tour represents both an opportunity and a challenge. It has the potential to inspire a generation and elevate football's status in India, but only if it is supported by long-term planning and grassroots development. The true success of the tour will depend not on the applause it receives, but on the lasting changes it inspires in India's sporting culture.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Which of the following outcomes would the author most likely consider evidence of failure of Messi's India tour? 1

- A. Increased viewership of football matches during the tour
- B. Growth in football-related social media engagement
- C. Lack of sustained funding for school-level football programmes
- D. Short-term rise in tourism revenue

II. Which statement best captures the cause-effect relationship criticised by the author? 1

- A. Media attention automatically improves sports infrastructure
- B. Inspiration inevitably leads to professional success
- C. Financial investment guarantees athletic excellence
- D. Celebrity presence is often mistaken for systemic progress

III. Explain how the author differentiates between symbolic impact and substantive development in the context of Messi's India tour. 2

IV. Complete the following appropriately: 1

The debate over financial expenditure reflects a deeper concern about whether visibility can substitute for _____ reform.

V. The author's concluding remark about "applause" symbolically represents: 1

- A. Public approval without accountability
- B. Economic profit from ticket sales
- C. Media exaggeration of success
- D. Fan admiration for international athletes

VI. If the passage were extended, which argument would most logically follow? 1

- A. A detailed comparison of Messi with other football legends
- B. Statistical analysis of tourism revenue from sports events
- C. Policy recommendations for integrating inspiration with infrastructure
- D. A historical account of football's origin in India

VII. If a state government allocates major funds to host international players but reduces funding for local sports academies, how would this decision conflict with the passage's argument? 2

VIII. Complete the following appropriately: 1

The author implies that celebrity visits function best as a _____ rather than a substitute for institutional reform.

2. Read the following passage. 10

1. In an era dominated by digital technology and smartwatches, the charm of vintage timepieces remains undiminished. These mechanical marvels, often handcrafted with precision, represent a bygone era where time was measured with gears, springs, and meticulous craftsmanship.
2. Collectors and enthusiasts are drawn to vintage watches not just for their intricate designs but also for the history they encapsulate. Each watch tells a story of its era, the technological advancements of the time, and the personal tales of its previous owners.
3. One of the primary reasons for the enduring appeal of these timepieces is their tangibility. In a world of intangible digital assets, the tactile experience of winding a watch and feeling its gears move is unparalleled.

Moreover, the sustainability aspect cannot be overlooked. Vintage watches, when maintained, can last for generations, making them eco-friendly compared to disposable modern gadgets.

4. However, collecting and maintaining vintage watches is not without its challenges. Authentic pieces are becoming rarer, and the expertise required to repair and restore them is dwindling. Additionally, the cost of acquiring pristine vintage pieces has skyrocketed due to their increasing demand.
5. Despite these hurdles, the allure of vintage watches remains strong. They serve as a bridge between the past and present, reminding us of the timeless nature of craftsmanship and the transient nature of time itself.

No.	Survey Statements	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
1	Vintage watches are eco-friendly compared to modern gadgets	235	105	40	10	10
2	The tactile experience of vintage watches is unique	245	100	40	10	5
3	Acquiring vintage watches has become expensive	230	110	45	10	5
4	Expertise in repairing vintage watches is rare	220	115	50	10	5
5	Vintage timepieces tell stories of their era	240	105	40	10	5
6	Modern gadgets will replace vintage watches	200	90	70	30	10

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- I. Which inference is most strongly supported when the survey data is analysed alongside the passage? 1
 - A. Emotional attachment is the sole reason for collecting vintage watches
 - ☒ B. Sustainability significantly influences positive perception of vintage watches
 - ☒ C. Cost is the primary barrier preventing new collectors
 - ☒ D. Modern gadgets are widely expected to replace vintage watches

- II. If a policymaker promotes repair-based industries, how could the data in Statement 4 be used to justify such an initiative? 1

- III. Analyse how the tactile experience described in the passage contributes to resistance against full digital replacement, as reflected in the survey. 2

- IV. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those given in the brackets. 1
The rising cost of vintage watches may unintentionally strengthen their _____ (exclusivity / accessibility) among collectors.

- V. Which survey trend best explains why vintage watches "serve as a bridge between the past and present"? 1
 - A. High agreement on eco-friendliness
 - B. Recognition of historical storytelling
 - C. Rising acquisition costs
 - D. Concern over replacement by modern gadgets

- VI. Explain how the concept of sustainability in the passage extends beyond environmental concerns. 2

VII. How does the rarity of repair expertise influence both the economic and cultural value of vintage watches? 2

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR

(20 marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of twelve of the following tasks, as directed.

I. Identify the error and supply the correction for the following statement.
Scarcely had the meeting begun when the power failed.

1

ERROR	CORRECTION

II. Report the following sentence correctly:
He said, "Let us not waste time."

1

III. Identify the sentence with incorrect agreement:

1

- A. The jury have given their verdict.
- B. Each of the answers is correct.
- C. Ten kilometres are a long distance to walk.
- D. The police are investigating the case.

IV. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank:

1

His means _____ (is/are) small but his heart is generous.

V. Identify the error and supply the correction for the following statement.

1

She must have finished the work by now, isn't it?

ERROR	CORRECTION

VI. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank:

1

I wish I _____ more careful while filling the form yesterday.

- A. am
- B. were
- C. had been
- D. have been

VII. Choose the correct tense form for the following sentence:

1

I _____ for half an hour when this serial ends.

- A. will be writing
- B. shall be writing
- C. shall have been writing
- D. will have written

VIII. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line, from a short ghost story: 1

So, who helped me arrive there safely without a compass or a radio, but without any more fuel in my tanks?

Option No.	Error	Correction
A	who	whom
B	a	the
C	but	and
D	tank,	tanks.

IX. Report the following sentence correctly: 1

She proposed to me that we should go to Dakpatthar for a picnic.

X. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank: 1

Much of his wealth _____ (has/have) been wasted.

XI. Choose the sentence where the determiner is used incorrectly: 1

A. Each of the players was given a medal.

B. Every students must carry an ID card.

C. Neither answer seems convincing.

D. Much effort has been put into the project.

XII. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank with an appropriate modal verb. 1

Given the satellite data discrepancies, the committee _____ have reached a premature conclusion.

A. must

B. might

C. should

D. would

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose

4A You are Manohar Nair, residing at R-45, Shastri Nagar, New Delhi-110052. You recently read a news report given below. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily highlighting the irony of modern development, in about 120–150 words. 5

India: As New Delhi chokes, air quality data under scrutiny



OR

4B You are Ananya Verma, residing at H.No. 56, Lake View Colony, Bhopal – 462016. You are deeply concerned about the rapid degradation of the Aravalli range due to illegal mining and deforestation. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily expressing your concern and suggesting urgent measures to save the Aravallis, in about 120–150 words.

5



5A The table below lists the various timings for drinking coffee soon after it is made for a customer along with a recommendation for an ideal time when the coffee should be consumed. Study the information and then analyze it in the form of a paragraph in about 100-120 words. In conclusion say when Mr. James can get the best out of his cup of coffee.

5

WHEN SHOULD MR. JAMES DRINK HIS COFFEE?		
QUANTITATIVE DATA		QUALITATIVE DATA
Time (Minutes)	Temperature (Celsius)	Drinkability
0	80	scalding
1	75	painful tongue burn
1.5	70	mild tongue burn
5.5	65	blow on it and take a small sip
8	60	perfect to sip
13	55	perfect to gulp
20	50	good, not great
26	45	pretty warm and passable
33	40	warm and slightly unpleasant
41	35	cool and uninviting

OR

5B Given below is some information about a promising young music artist. Study the information carefully and then write an analytical paragraph in about 100-120 words suggesting:

5

What Should Pranav Wahi Do?

Pranav Wahi (20 years unmarried male)

Profession : Guitarist, Lyricist, Music Producer

Training : Foundation Course in Instrumental Music (Guitar) from KMMP AR Rahman Music Academy (1 year ago) and 1 Year Music Production Course from Sonic Field Music Production Academy, NOIDA (in progress)

Source of Income : Support from father, stage shows, background music score for artists/singers/rappers, TV shows, and short films

Marriage Plans : Not in any relationship currently, no plan for marriage for the next five years

Ultimate Aim : Produce music for Bollywood films, do solo shows, establish own band with like-minded musicians, launch albums and singles of own songs, judge a reality show, teach music at a renowned institute, win Grammy award

SECTION C

LITERATURE TEXTBOOK

(40 marks)

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two.

5

A. "Kisa Gotami carried the dead child to all her neighbours, asking them for medicine."

I. Kisa Gotami's action symbolises:

1

- A. Ignorance of death
- B. Blind faith in miracles
- ✓ C. Human refusal to accept impermanence
- D. Social dependence

II. The Buddha's message challenges the belief that:

1

- A. Death is sudden
- B. Emotional release leads to healing
- C. Rituals can end suffering
- ✓ D. Suffering is permanent

III. Why is silence and realization more powerful than verbal consolation in this lesson?

2

IV. Kisa Gotami's journey reflects a shift from _____ suffering to _____ understanding.

1

OR

B. "He stalks in his vivid stripes
The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet,
In his quiet rage."

I. The tiger's movement inside the cage symbolises:

1

- A. Adaptation to captivity
- B. Physical weakness
- C. Futility of confined strength
- D. Human sympathy

II. Explain how the tiger becomes a metaphor rather than a literal animal.

2

III. The figure of speech in "quiet rage" is _____.

1

IV. The word "vivid" contrasts with the cage to suggest:

1

- A. Beauty ignored by humans
- B. The tiger's adaptability
- C. Conflict between vitality and confinement
- D. Decorative appeal

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two.

5

A. "I felt very nervous when I counted the money."

I. The narrator's nervousness indicates:

1

- A. Fear of being caught
- B. Moral conflict
- C. Inexperience
- D. Suspicion of Anil

II. Anil's response to the theft reflects his belief in:

1

- A. Punishment
- B. Forgiveness
- C. Trust-based reform
- D. Social discipline

III. Why does possession of money fail to provide emotional security?

2

IV. Assertion (A): The narrator's continued use of manipulation indicates failure of moral reform.

1

Reason (R): Moral transformation is gradual and may coexist with old survival habits.

- A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B. Both are true, but R is not the correct explanation
- C. A is true, R is false
- D. A is false, R is true

OR

B. "She was glad to find so many girls almost of her own age present there. She hoped that one of them would become her friend."

I. Bholi's hope in this moment reveals her:

1

- A. Social confidence
- B. Emotional deprivation
- C. Competitive instinct
- D. Desire for attention

- I. This line subtly contrasts: 1
- Childhood innocence and fear
 - Individual loneliness and social inclusion
 - Rural and urban life
 - Education and ignorance

III. Why is Bholi's desire for friendship more significant than her fear of school? 2

IV. Suppose Bholi had not found girls of her age at school. How might this have affected her transformation? 1

8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions, in about 50 words each. 4×3=12

I. Discuss how Valli's refusal of help reflects emotional maturity rather than pride. 3

II. The tea estates appear vast and orderly. Explain how this visual description contributes to the theme of economic and cultural significance of tea. 3

III. Evaluate the role of instinct versus conscious decision-making in the seagull's first flight. 3

IV. Assess how the poem Amandal critiques adult authority without portraying adults as villains. 3

V. The post office employees choose anonymity while helping Lencho. Explore the ethical value of this decision. 3

9. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. 2×3=6

I. Evaluate how Dr Herriot's decision to withhold medicines reflects a deeper understanding of treatment beyond prescriptions. 3

II. Ebright's success is often credited to his mother. Discuss why her role was catalytic rather than controlling. 3

III. How does Griffin's inability to foresee consequences highlight a critical flaw in his scientific mindset? 3

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. 1×6=6

A. Analyse how both texts For Anne Gregory and Mijbil the Otter emphasise the right to individuality—human or animal—against imposed identities. Why is respecting individuality a key competency in a diverse society? 6

OR

A Tiger in The Zoo.
B. Analyse how both texts Nelson Mandela and *How to Tell Wild Animals* address the misuse or misunderstanding of power—political authority in one and human dominance over nature in the other. Apply this idea to modern environmental or social conflicts. 6

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. 1×6=6

A. Both Ausable and Horace Danby succeed in deceiving others, yet only one emerges morally intact. Analyze how intention, situational awareness and ethical reasoning differentiate intelligence from cleverness in these two characters. Apply this distinction to a real-life situation where smart decision-making must also be ethical. 6

OR

B. Both Matilda Loisel and the Martian invaders act on flawed assumptions—one about social status and the other about human intelligence. Analyze how false perception leads to self-inflicted loss in both texts. Apply this insight to a contemporary situation where assumptions can cause serious consequences.

6